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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part IV

International cooperation for development

Section 14

Environment

Programme 11

Environment

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 14)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 14)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 14.1 The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) is responsible for leading and coordinating action on environmental matters within the United Nations system. The mandate derives primarily from the priorities established in General Assembly resolution [2997 \(XXVII\)](#), decision 19/1 of the Governing Council of UNEP and the Nairobi Declaration on the Role and Mandate of the United Nations Environment Programme, which the Assembly endorsed in 1997 in the annex to its resolution [S-19/2](#) and further reaffirmed in its resolutions [53/242](#), in 1999, and [66/288](#) and [67/213](#), in 2012. In Assembly resolution [70/1](#), Member States recognized the importance of the environmental dimension to the successful implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Within its mandate, UNEP supports normative processes, frameworks and tools and regional and country actions that demonstrate and promote the coherent implementation of the environmental dimension of sustainable development.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 14.2 Delivery of the 2027 programme plan is part of the effort to implement the UNEP medium-term strategy for the period 2026–2029. By leveraging science, strengthening environmental governance and encouraging global cooperation, UNEP aims to tackle environmental challenges and support coordinated and impactful action. Its three thematic subprogrammes (climate action, nature action and chemicals and pollution action) will drive the medium-term strategy vision, while the two foundational subprogrammes (subprogramme 4, Environmental law and governance, and subprogramme 7, Science-policy) and two enabling subprogrammes (subprogramme 2, Digital transformations in supporting environmental action, and subprogramme 6, Finance and economic transformations) will, respectively, deliver the vision – through science, environmental governance, finance and economic instruments and digital tools and platforms – to enhance international cooperation, strengthen capacity-building and share good practices.
- 14.3 With regard to cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, subregional, national and local levels, UNEP will continue to raise ambitions and promote leadership through advocacy and a normative and standard-setting approach. It will support Member States through transformative strategic partnerships that deliver sustainable solutions, integrating health, education, poverty reduction, and economic and social well-being. Its partnerships with the secretariats of multilateral environmental agreements will remain pivotal to securing stronger synergies and enhancing the impact of the work of the relevant parties. UNEP will encourage non-governmental stakeholders, including the private sector and the finance community, to increase investment in new and renewable sources of energy and improve environmental sustainability. Within the context of those partnerships, action will be aimed at making a broader impact in support of sustainable development, while strengthening the ability of countries to rapidly respond to the environmental impacts of disasters and armed conflicts.
- 14.4 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, UNEP, as Chair of the United Nations Environment Management Group, will continue to support and enhance coordination, cooperation and collaboration across the United Nations through system-wide strategies and common approaches on the environment, such as the common approach to biodiversity and the common approach towards a pollution-free planet. In addition, UNEP will help integrate the priorities of multilateral environmental agreements into United Nations country programming, ensuring a more coordinated and effective response to specific country needs. It will also enhance its guiding role, raise ambitions and accelerate and scale up progress to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals. It will continue to focus on ensuring that its work is reflected and embedded in the new generation of United Nations

country teams and the reinvigorated resident coordinator system through engagement with the Development Coordination Office and to leverage its work and expertise at the regional, subregional and country levels. UNEP will also integrate the priorities of the multilateral environmental agreements into global follow-up and review processes, in particular the 2030 Agenda.

- 14.5 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
- (a) Member States and partners remain committed to the development and implementation of science-based environmental policies;
 - (b) The continued availability of extrabudgetary funding for the implementation of UNEP planned activities.
- 14.6 UNEP integrates a gender perspective into its operational activities, deliverables and results, as appropriate. UNEP will continue to support Member States in mainstreaming gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls, utilizing disaggregated data and calling for women's meaningful participation at all levels of environmental decision-making.
- 14.7 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, UNEP will continue to integrate disability inclusion and related guidance into its strategic, policy, programmatic and operational interventions. Engagement with organizations of persons with disabilities will be institutionalized to ensure a participatory approach to the implementation of the UNEP programme of work. Following lessons learned from the seventh session of the United Nations Environment Assembly, UNEP will establish structured mechanisms to assess accessibility needs in advance of major meetings and will conduct accessibility audits of digital platforms in line with the standards set out in the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 14.8 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the tables of deliverables reflect updated planning deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026.
- 14.9 UNEP will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs. This includes, among others, any decisions taken in connection with a thorough assessment – led by UNEP and the secretariat of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change – of current arrangements for environmental responsibilities which are dispersed across United Nations entities with a view to making proposals on possible structural changes and programme realignments on environmental issues, as appropriate.

Legislative mandates

- 14.10 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

2997 (XXVII)	Institutional and financial arrangements for international environmental cooperation	55/198	Enhancing complementarities among international instruments related to environment and sustainable development
47/190	Report of the United Nations Conference on Environment and Development	66/288	The future we want
53/242	Report of the Secretary-General on environment and human settlements	67/251	Change of the designation of the Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme

Part IV International cooperation for development

68/215	Report of the Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme on its first universal session and the implementation of section IV.C, entitled “Environmental pillar in the context of sustainable development”, of the outcome document of the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development	79/209	Report of the United Nations Environment Assembly of the United Nations Environment Programme
70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	79/228	Towards global partnerships: a principle-based approach to enhanced cooperation between the United Nations and all relevant partners
74/209	International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste	79/313	Tackling illicit trafficking in wildlife
74/212	International Day of Clean Air for blue skies	80/32	Observance of environmental norms in the drafting and implementation of agreements on disarmament and arms control
74/216	Implementation of Agenda 21, the Programme for the Further Implementation of Agenda 21 and the outcomes of the World Summit on Sustainable Development and of the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development	80/75	Effects of atomic radiation
75/271	Nature knows no borders: transboundary cooperation – a key factor for biodiversity conservation, restoration and sustainable use	80/113	International cooperation on humanitarian assistance in the field of natural disasters, from relief to development
76/300	The human right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment	80/121	International trade and development
77/159	Enhancing the role of parliaments in accelerating the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals	80/122	International financial system and development
77/161	Promoting zero-waste initiatives to advance the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	80/127	Promoting investments for sustainable development
78/128	2025 United Nations Conference to Support the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 14: Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development	80/135	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21
78/146	Cooperative measures to assess and increase awareness of environmental effects related to waste originating from chemical munitions dumped at sea	80/137	Disaster risk reduction
79/1	The Pact for the Future	80/139	Implementation of the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification in Those Countries Experiencing Serious Drought and/or Desertification, particularly in Africa
79/203	Follow-up to and implementation of the SIDS Accelerated Modalities of Action (SAMOA) Pathway and the Mauritius Strategy for the Further Implementation of the Programme of Action for the Sustainable Development of Small Island Developing States	80/143	Combating sand and dust storms
79/204	Towards the sustainable development of the Caribbean Sea for present and future generations	80/147	Science, technology and innovation for sustainable development
		80/149	Development cooperation with middle-income countries
		80/150	Follow-up to the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries
		80/155	Operational activities for development of the United Nations system
		80/178	Implementation of the outcome of the World Summit for Social Development and of the twenty-fourth special session of the General Assembly
		80/180	Policies and programmes involving youth
		80/191	Rights of Indigenous Peoples
		80/216	The human rights to safe drinking water and sanitation

Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme decisions

19/1	Nairobi Declaration on the Role and Mandate of the United Nations Environment Programme	27/4	Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services
23/1, sect. I	Implementation of decision SS.VII/1 on international environmental governance: Bali Strategic Plan for Technology Support and Capacity-building	27/8	Green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication

United Nations Environment Assembly resolutions

1/4	Science-policy interface	4/23	Keeping the world environment under review: enhancing the United Nations Environment Programme science-policy interface and endorsement of the Global Environment Outlook
1/8	Ecosystems-based adaptation		
1/11	Coordination across the United Nations system in the field of the environment, including the Environment Management Group	5/1	Animal welfare – environment – sustainable development nexus
1/12	Relationship between the United Nations Environment Programme and multilateral environmental agreements	5/3	Future of the Global Environment Outlook
1/13	Implementation of Principle 10 of the Rio Declaration on Environment and Development	5/8	Science-policy panel to contribute further to the sound management of chemicals and waste and to prevent pollution
1/16	Management of trust funds and earmarked contributions	5/9	Sustainable and resilient infrastructure
2/4	Role, functions and modalities for United Nations Environment Programme implementation of the SAMOA Pathway as a means of facilitating achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals	5/11	Enhancing circular economy as a contribution to achieving sustainable consumption and production
2/5	Delivering on the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	5/12	Environmental aspects of minerals and metals management
2/6	Supporting the Paris Agreement	6/1	Circularity of a resilient and low-carbon sugar cane agro-industry
2/13	Sustainable management of natural capital for sustainable development and poverty eradication	6/2	Amendments to the Instrument for the Establishment of the Restructured Global Environment Facility
2/16	Mainstreaming of biodiversity for well-being	6/4	Promoting synergies, cooperation or collaboration for national implementation of multilateral environmental agreements and other relevant environmental instruments
2/17	Enhancing the work of the United Nations Environment Programme in facilitating cooperation, collaboration and synergies among biodiversity-related conventions	6/5	Environmental aspects of minerals and metals
2/19	Midterm review of the fourth Programme for the Development and Periodic Review of Environmental Law (Montevideo Programme IV)	6/6	Fostering national action to address global environmental challenges through increased cooperation between the United Nations Environment Assembly, the United Nations Environment Programme and multilateral environmental agreements
2/24	Combating desertification, land degradation and drought and promoting sustainable pastoralism and rangelands	6/7	Combating sand and dust storms
3/1	Pollution mitigation and control in areas affected by armed conflict or terrorism	6/8	Promoting sustainable lifestyles
3/2	Pollution mitigation by mainstreaming biodiversity into key sectors	6/12	Environmental assistance and recovery in areas affected by armed conflict
3/4	Environment and health	6/14	Strengthening international efforts to combat desertification and land degradation, restore degraded land, promote land conservation and sustainable land management, contribute to land degradation neutrality and enhance drought resilience
3/6	Managing soil pollution to achieve sustainable development		
3/8	Preventing and reducing air pollution to improve air quality globally	6/15	Strengthening ocean efforts to tackle climate change, marine biodiversity loss and pollution
3/9	Eliminating exposure to lead paint and promoting environmentally sound management of waste lead-acid batteries	7/1	Accelerating global actions to promote the climate resilience of coral reefs
3/10	Addressing water pollution to protect and restore water-related ecosystems	7/5	Promoting synergies, cooperation or collaboration for national implementation of multilateral environmental agreements and other relevant environmental instruments
4/2	Promoting sustainable practices and innovative solutions for curbing food loss and waste	7/7	Strengthening the global management of wildfires
4/3	Sustainable mobility	7/10	Preservation of glaciers and the broader cryosphere, particularly in mountain regions
4/20	Fifth Programme for the Development and Periodic Review of Environmental Law (Montevideo V): delivering for people and the planet		

Subprogramme 1
Climate action

General Assembly resolutions

69/225	Promotion of new and renewable sources of energy	80/138	Protection of global climate for present and future generations of humankind
73/230	Effective global response to address the impacts of the El Niño phenomenon	80/142	Ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all

Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme decision

27/10	Climate Technology Centre and Network
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Subprogramme 2
Digital transformations in supporting environmental action

General Assembly resolutions

80/118	Information and communications technologies for sustainable development	80/173	Outcome document of the high-level meeting of the General Assembly on the overall review of the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society
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United Nations Environment Assembly resolution

7/9	Environmental sustainability of artificial intelligence systems
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Subprogramme 3
Nature action

General Assembly resolutions

65/161	Convention on Biological Diversity	80/144	Sustainable mountain development
68/205	World Wildlife Day	80/157	Agriculture development, food security and nutrition
79/210	Harmony with Nature		
80/110	Oceans and the law of the sea		
80/140	Implementation of the Convention on Biological Diversity and its contribution to sustainable development		

Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme decisions

26/14	Global Environment Monitoring System/Water Programme	27/3	International water quality guidelines for ecosystems
26/16	Promoting South-South cooperation on biodiversity for development		

United Nations Environment Assembly resolutions

1/9	Global Environment Monitoring System/Water Programme (GEMS/Water)	4/16	Conservation and sustainable management of peatlands
2/10	Oceans and seas	5/4	Sustainable lake management
2/14	Illegal trade in wildlife and wildlife products	5/5	Nature-based solutions for supporting sustainable development
4/10	Innovation on biodiversity and land degradation	5/6	Biodiversity and health
4/12	Sustainable management for global health of mangroves	7/4	Strengthening the global response to the massive influx of sargassum seaweed blooms
4/13	Sustainable coral reefs management		
4/15	Innovations in sustainable rangelands and pastoralism		

Subprogramme 4
Environmental law and governance

Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme ministerial declarations and decisions

SS.VI/1	Malmö Ministerial Declaration	25/11	Environmental law
SS.VII/4	Compliance with and enforcement of multilateral environmental agreements	27/5	Coordination across the United Nations system, including the Environment Management Group
SS.XII/3	International environmental governance	27/9	Advancing justice, governance and law for environmental sustainability
24/4	Prevention of illegal international trade		

Subprogramme 5
Chemicals and pollution action

General Assembly resolution

79/2	Political declaration of the high-level meeting on antimicrobial resistance
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Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme decisions

SS.IX/1	Strategic Approach to International Chemicals Management	SS.XII/5	Enhancing cooperation and coordination within the chemicals and wastes cluster
SS.XII/4	Consultative process on financing options for chemicals and wastes	25/5 27/12	Chemicals management, including mercury Chemicals and waste management

United Nations Environment Assembly resolutions

4/6	Marine plastic litter and microplastics	6/11	Highly hazardous pesticides
4/9	Addressing single-use plastic products pollution	7/3	Strengthening international cooperation on the environmentally sound management of minerals and metals
4/21	Implementation plan “Towards a pollution-free planet”	7/8	Sound management of chemicals and waste
5/2	Sustainable nitrogen management	7/11	Environmental dimensions of antimicrobial resistance
5/14	End plastic pollution: towards an international legally binding instrument		
6/10	Promoting regional cooperation on air pollution to improve air quality globally		

Subprogramme 6
Finance and economic transformations

United Nations Environment Assembly resolutions

4/1	Innovative pathways to achieve sustainable consumption and production	4/5	Sustainable infrastructure
4/4	Addressing environmental challenges through sustainable business practices		

Subprogramme 7
Science-policy

Governing Council of the United Nations Environment Programme decision

SS.X/5	Global Environment Outlook: environment for development
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United Nations Environment Assembly ministerial declaration

UNEP/EA.7/HLS/1	Ministerial declaration of the United Nations Environment Assembly at its seventh session: advancing sustainable solutions for a resilient planet
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Deliverables

14.11 Table 14.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 14.1

Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Conference and secretariat services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	4	4	3	4
Meetings of:				
1. United Nations Environment Assembly	1	1	–	1
2. Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	1	1	1
3. Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
4. Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	2	2	1
5. To assess environmental risks from disasters and armed conflicts	1	1	1	1
6. On institutional and legal frameworks to improve national and local preparedness to mitigate environmental risks from disasters and armed conflicts	1	1	1	–
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	3	2
7. On disaster risk reduction, preparedness assessments and road maps	2	2	2	1
8. UNEP annual report	1	1	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to humanitarian actors, the United Nations system and relevant government stakeholders on addressing the environmental impacts of disasters and armed conflicts and, upon request, technical support to up to 10 Member States to strengthen environmental risk reduction, emergency response, recovery and related climate-security considerations in support of the Sustainable Development Goals.				

Evaluation activities

14.12 The following evaluations completed in 2025 have guided the proposed programme plan for 2027:

- (a) Office of Internal Oversight Services thematic evaluation of Sustainable Development Goal climate-focused partnerships;
- (b) UNEP evaluation of subprogramme 5, Chemicals and pollution action, during the period 2015-2024.

14.13 In response to the results of the evaluations referenced above, UNEP will seek to develop tailored partnership strategies that incorporate Secretariat-level guidance, ensuring clear operational guidelines on private sector engagement. This will help establish partnerships that are both purpose-driven and effective and will create clear road maps, including measurable targets that align with globally recognized frameworks, such as the Paris Agreement. UNEP will also increase efforts towards elevating the visibility and strategic importance of sound management of chemicals and waste and pollution prevention and control, across the United Nations system, especially among the United Nations country teams.

14.14 An evaluation of subprogramme 7, conducted by UNEP, is planned for 2027.

Programme of work

Subprogramme 1

Climate action

Objective

- 14.15 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance the transition of countries to low-emission economic development and increase their adaptation and resilience to climate change.

Strategy

- 14.16 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support Member States with the most up-to-date science to underpin national and international policy-setting;
 - (b) Provide guidance and technical assistance on climate plans, sectoral road maps, transparency and technology transfer to support Member States in fulfilling their climate obligations under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change and the Paris Agreement;
 - (c) Accelerate sectoral transformation models to help Member States with low-emission development and increased adaptation and resilience;
 - (d) Build the technical capacity of Member States and subnational governments to scale sectoral solutions through private sector partnerships and innovative climate finance.
- 14.17 These workstreams will help Member States make progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goal 13.
- 14.18 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Member States translating science and policy recommendations into actionable and investable climate plans that strengthen sustainable development and increasing their capacity to monitor progress transparently and efficiently;
 - (b) Member States lowering greenhouse gas emissions by implementing sectoral mitigation solutions, including in the energy, transport, cooling, construction and land use sectors;
 - (c) Member States enhancing resilience and adaptation to the impacts of climate change, including through nature-based solutions and improved multi-hazard monitoring, forecasting and early warning systems;
 - (d) Member States using climate strategies (e.g. nationally determined contributions, national adaptation plans and biennial transparency reviews) to guide investment and attract innovative, concessional and private finance to accelerate mitigation, adaptation and resilience.

Programme performance in 2025

Cities commit to sustainable cooling targets

- 14.19 In its *Global Cooling Watch report for 2025, entitled The Free Degrees: How Sustainable, Passive-First Cooling Can Save Lives, Money and Food*, UNEP warns that cooling demand could more than triple by 2050, reaching 10 per cent of global emissions. In the report, UNEP outlines a sustainable cooling pathway, combining passive cooling, higher energy efficiency standards and accelerated phase-down of hydrofluorocarbons, which could reduce cooling-related emissions by up to 97 per cent. In response, the subprogramme has supported the advancement of a global agenda, including convening 72 Member States under the Global Cooling Pledge, backed by the newly launched

Enabling Pledge Implementation for Cooling Facility to provide technical assistance and funding for heat action plans and pilots, and initiating an Intergovernmental Committee on Cooling, launched at the 2025 United Nations Climate Change Conference. The Intergovernmental Committee on Cooling monitors and accelerates the 14 targets of the Global Cooling Pledge. Since 2025, the subprogramme has been providing national and subnational signatories of the Global Cooling Pledge access to financial support for pilot deployment, technical guidance, policy support, capacity-building and feasibility assessments through the Enabling Pledge Implementation for Cooling Facility.

14.20 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 14.2).

Table 14.2
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Launched at the 2023 United Nations Climate Change Conference, the Global Cooling Pledge is the world's first collective commitment to reducing cooling-related emissions by at least 68 per cent by 2050, while expanding access to sustainable cooling	–	185 cities committed to the Global Cooling Pledge through the Beat the Heat implementation drive, launched at the 2025 United Nations Climate Change Conference held in Belém, Brazil, accelerating city-level action on sustainable cooling

Planned results for 2027

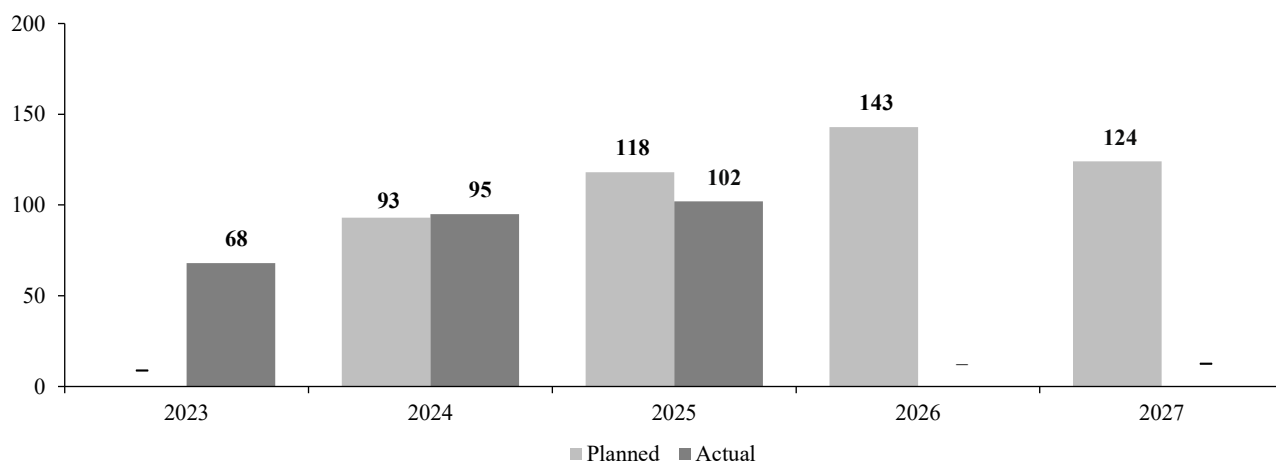
Result 1: Member States develop national methane road maps and action plans

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.21 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development of 102 national methane road maps and action plans, which did not meet the planned target of 118. The target was not met because support provided by the subprogramme was shifted to be focused on the inclusion of methane targets in Member States' submissions for nationally determined contributions 3.0.
- 14.22 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.I).

Figure 14.I

Performance measure: number of countries that have developed national methane road maps and action plans (cumulative)



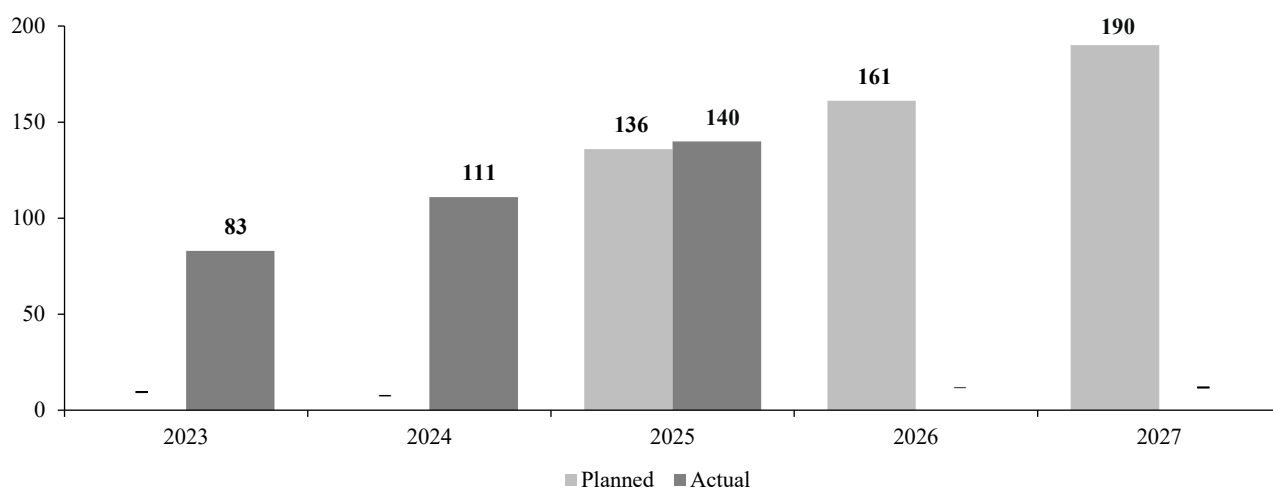
Result 2: Member States adopt environmentally sound technologies for climate change mitigation and adaptation

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.23 The subprogramme's work contributed to equipping 140 countries with the means to implement technology policies and solutions for climate mitigation and adaptation, which exceeded the planned target of 136 countries.
- 14.24 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.II).

Figure 14.II

Performance measure: number of countries equipped to implement technology policies and solutions for climate mitigation and adaptation (cumulative)



Result 3: governments at the national and subnational levels adopt climate adaptation strategies and policies, including national adaptation plans

Proposed programme plan for 2027

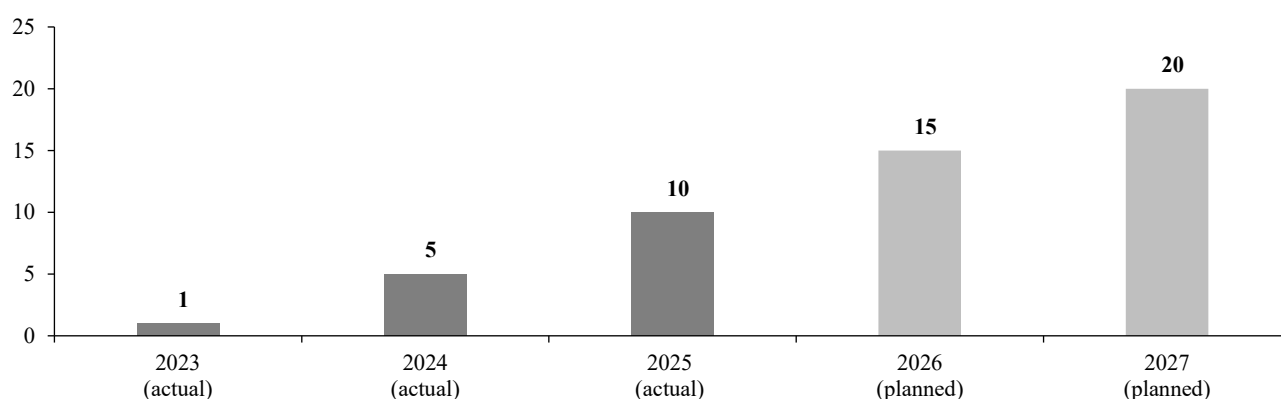
- 14.25 In its Adaptation Gap Report 2025, entitled *Running on Empty: The World Is Gearing Up for Climate Resilience – Without the Money to Get There*, UNEP updated the estimated adaptation finance needs to be \$310 billion annually by 2035; meanwhile, at its thirtieth session, held in Brazil, the Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change emphasized robust adaptation plans and measurement, including the launch of the Belém-Addis vision on adaptation, a two-year policy alignment process by Parties, aimed at developing guidance for operationalizing the Belém Adaptation Indicators under the Belém-Addis vision on adaptation. The subprogramme provides support through a range of activities that help Member States in adopting adaptation policies and strategies. UNEP implements the Global Ecosystem-based Adaptation Fund, hosts the secretariat of the Global Adaptation Network, co-leads the World Adaptation Science Programme and effectively executes a wide portfolio of projects financed by the Global Environmental Facility, the Green Climate Fund and the Adaptation Fund.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 14.26 The lesson for the subprogramme was that its support for adaptation interventions was effective when the interventions were locally owned and supported by inclusive, multi-stakeholder partnerships and when there was financing available for implementation. In applying these lessons, the subprogramme will strengthen institutional capacities to lead adaptation efforts nationally and locally, replicate proven infrastructure models, increase private co-financing and enhance the availability of climate adaptation data to better support governments at different levels in developing and adopting climate adaptation strategies and policies that reflect their individual circumstances.
- 14.27 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.III).

Figure 14.III

Performance measure: governments at the national and subnational levels that have adopted climate adaptation strategies and policies with United Nations Environment Programme support (cumulative)



Deliverables

- 14.28 Table 14.3 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.3

Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	3	29	3	20
1. On mitigation and adaptation technologies through the Climate Technology Centre and Network	3	29	3	20
Publications (number of publications)	6	6	6	6
2. On mitigation, renewable energy, energy efficiency and the energy sector	3	3	3	3
3. On adaptation and resilience (assessments and tools)	3	3	3	3
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to 85 countries on climate matters, including South-South cooperation, ecosystem-based adaptation, climate financing, short-lived climate pollutants, low-emission development, sustainable energy and energy efficiency, and REDD-plus.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: 50 side events, media outreach, goodwill ambassador outreach, 5 Global Adaptation Network newsletters and 16 events on climate action, reaching an audience in excess of 1 million.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: 16 stories and 5 videos for social media platforms and web pages.				

Subprogramme 2

Digital transformations in supporting environmental action

Objective

- 14.29 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance the use of data and analytics on environmental issues to allow more effective policies, decisions, actions and investments by Member States and the private sector, supporting multilateral environmental agreements and Sustainable Development Goal targets related to climate, nature, land, oceans and freshwater bodies and pollution.

Strategy

- 14.30 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- Develop and maintain interoperable data systems, standards and analytical tools to support Sustainable Development Goal monitoring and the tracking of environmental impacts and compliance;
 - Provide digital platforms and technical support services to Member States, related to access to, the integration of and the use of environmental data and evidence for policy development, planning and decision-making;
 - Build digital capacity for environmental policy, planning and action, including through inclusive approaches, strengthened digital literacy, the integration of digital tools into national development planning and enhanced regional cooperation, particularly in developing countries, including the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States;
 - Provide technical guidance, advisory services and capacity-building to Member States and partners on the responsible use of artificial intelligence and other digital technologies for environmental policy and action, including an understanding of opportunities, risks and governance approaches;

- (e) Develop and disseminate shared principles, standards and good practices to promote environmentally sustainable and risk-informed digital innovation.
- 14.31 These workstreams will help Member States make progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, in particular Goals 9, 10, 16 and 17.
- 14.32 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
 - (a) Timely, evidence-based decision-making on environmental issues at the national and global levels;
 - (b) Policy coherence and improved accountability of Member States for progress towards internationally agreed environmental and development targets, including the Sustainable Development Goals and multilateral environmental agreements;
 - (c) Data-driven environmental policies, plans and investments, particularly in developing countries, including the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, contributing to reduced digital divides and enhanced regional and cross-border cooperation;
 - (d) Increased adoption and responsible use of artificial intelligence and other emerging digital technologies for environmental applications, guided by sustainability principles and best practices that support innovation, while managing environmental, social and economic risks.

Programme performance in 2025

Governments and policymakers gained access to an artificial intelligence-powered environment portal

- 14.33 In 2025, the subprogramme launched EnvironmentGPT, an artificial intelligence-powered digital assistant designed to improve access to trusted, policy-relevant environmental knowledge. Developed as part of UNEP digital transformation efforts, it builds on prior investments in interoperable data governance approaches, with a focus on environmental data, knowledge management and responsible artificial intelligence. The tool enables users to query UNEP-curated environmental content through natural language, returning structured, cited responses drawn from authoritative UNEP publications and data sources. The public beta launch at the seventh session of the United Nations Environment Assembly marked a milestone in operationalizing artificial intelligence to strengthen the science-policy interface and demonstrated a shift from static knowledge repositories towards a more interactive and user-centred access model for environmental information.
- 14.34 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 14.4).

Table 14.4
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Governments, policymakers, researchers and the public gain access to EnvironmentGPT to more easily discover, understand and apply environmental evidence in decision-making processes
		Initial user engagement reflected 16,790 requests recorded between 1 and 31 December 2025 following the public launch of EnvironmentGPT

Planned results for 2027

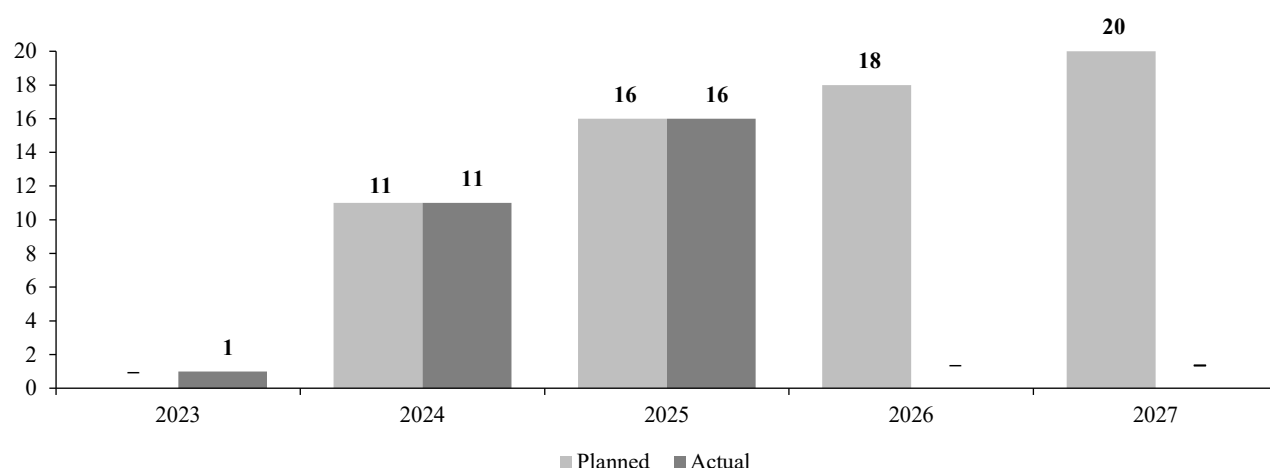
Result 1: increased interoperability of global environmental data

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.35 The subprogramme's work contributed to 16 data partnerships that enhanced the interoperability of global environmental data, which met the planned target.
- 14.36 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.IV).

Figure 14.IV

Performance measure: number of data partnerships that enhance the interoperability of global environmental data (cumulative)



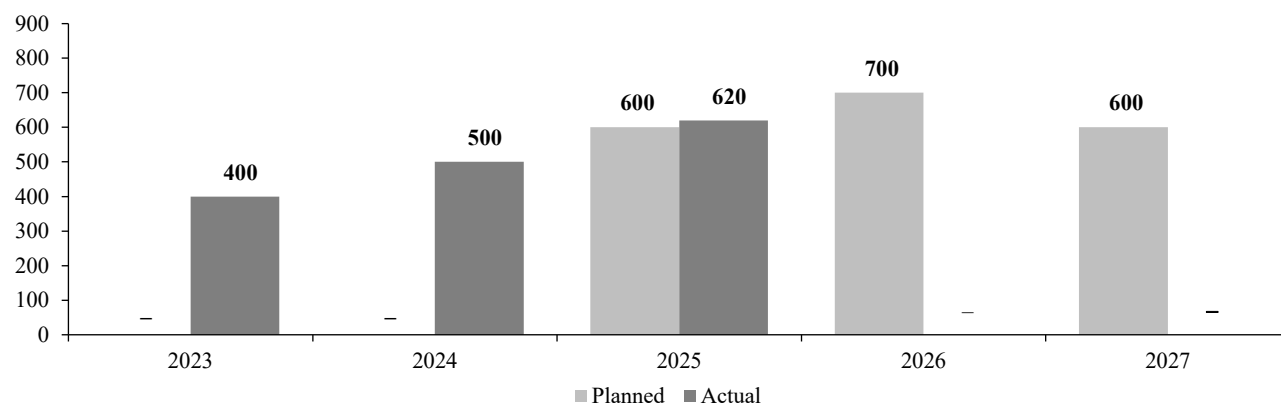
Result 2: strengthened digital capacities to drive environmental sustainability

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.37 The subprogramme's work contributed to equipping 620 stakeholders to utilize digital solutions to address environmental challenges, which exceeded the planned target of 600. Given the expected limited financial resources available to support Member States and other stakeholders with the uptake of digital solutions to address environmental challenges, the target for 2027 has been adjusted to 600, compared with 700 for 2026, to ensure alignment with the level of implementation capacity.
- 14.38 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.V).

Figure 14.V

Performance measure: number of stakeholders equipped to utilize digital solutions to address environmental challenges (annual)



Result 3: World Environment Situation Room informs policy decision-making

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 14.39 Fragmented availability of digital solutions and data sets across environmental thematic areas can constrain the ability of UNEP stakeholders to easily discover, access and use comprehensive environmental information. In recent years, the subprogramme has worked to improve the availability of digital environmental resources, digital platforms, interoperable data governance approaches and artificial intelligence-enabled information access.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 14.40 The lesson for the subprogramme was that consolidating digital solutions and data sets within a unified platform could enhance their visibility, discoverability and early uptake by intended users. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will place greater emphasis on integrating digital solutions and data sets across UNEP thematic areas within the World Environment Situation Room, with increased attention paid to initial uptake and use by countries and UNEP-supported stakeholders. This is expected to improve accessibility, coherence and initial uptake of environmental information by countries and UNEP stakeholders.
- 14.41 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 14.5).

Table 14.5

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	Representatives from 20 countries and institutional stakeholders, including United Nations entities, regional offices, research institutions, civil society organizations and partner institutions were engaged during the launch of the	5 countries and institutional stakeholders incorporate World Environment Situation Room environmental information into official reporting, policy analysis or institutional	5 additional countries and institutional stakeholders incorporate World Environment Situation Room environmental information into official reporting, policy analysis or institutional

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
		World Environment Situation Room	decision-support processes	decision-support processes

Deliverables

14.42 Table 14.6 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.6

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	3	4	4	4
1. Using the World Environment Situation Room at the global, regional or national levels	3	4	4	4
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	24	24	23	8
2. Training events on digital transformation for environmental sustainability – national training	6	6	6	–
3. Seminars and workshops on the development of a global environmental data strategy and digital cooperation framework	6	6	6	–
4. Seminars and workshops on alignment with the Global Environmental Data Strategy	–	–	–	3
5. Seminars and workshops on development of the World Environment Situation Room and identification of transformative applications	6	6	5 [6]	–
6. Seminars and workshops on the World Environment Situation Room and application of its use cases	–	–	–	3
7. Seminars and workshops on development and implementation of the environmental action plan for the Secretary-General's Road Map for Digital Cooperation	6	6	6	–
8. Seminars and workshops on the implementation of the Global Digital Compact	–	–	–	2
Publications (number of publications)	4	4	3	2
9. On digital technologies for achieving climate stability; living in harmony with nature: land, oceans and freshwater bodies; and achieving land degradation neutrality	4	4	3 [4]	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	2	2	1	1
10. On minimizing the environmental, climate and e-waste footprint of the information and communications technology sector	2	2	1 [2]	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice and technical support to approximately 5 Member States in the global South, upon request, on environmentally sustainable artificial intelligence, responsible digital governance and the implementation of the Global Environmental Data Strategy.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: World Environment Situation Room; and EnvironmentGPT.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 14).

Subprogramme 3

Nature action

Objective

- 14.43 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance actions to halt and reverse biodiversity loss; address desertification, land degradation and drought; and conserve and restore terrestrial, marine and freshwater ecosystems.

Strategy

- 14.44 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Enhance the capacity of Member States to sustainably manage and restore their natural and productive ecosystems;
 - (b) Strengthen the capacity of Member States to integrate the sustainable management of nature into development planning and other cross-sectoral decision-making frameworks;
 - (c) Promote a people-oriented approach to nature conservation, restoration and sustainable use, recognizing the importance of policies that support poverty eradication and the needs and livelihoods of biodiversity-dependent communities;
 - (d) Promote a whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach to addressing interrelated nature conservation and development challenges.
- 14.45 These workstreams will help Member States make progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, in particular Goals 3, 6, 12, 13, 14 and 15.
- 14.46 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Effective integration of sustainable management of biodiversity, land, freshwater bodies and oceans across sectors and systems;
 - (b) Increased extent of landscapes and seascapes under improved ecosystem management;
 - (c) Strengthened transparency, accountability and governance to deliver on biodiversity-, land-, freshwater- and ocean-related commitments;
 - (d) Greater public and private financial flows directed towards sustainable ecosystem management and restoration.

Programme performance in 2025

Member States commit to protecting marine biodiversity beyond national borders

- 14.47 The subprogramme has supported Member States in advancing the Agreement under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea on the Conservation and Sustainable Use of Marine Biological Diversity of Areas beyond National Jurisdiction, adopted in June 2023, to safeguard nearly two thirds of the ocean that lies beyond national jurisdiction. Through its national-level enabling activities initiative, the subprogramme provided guidance, training and readiness support to 28 countries, establishing enabling conditions for the ratification and implementation of the Agreement. This support was designed to benefit countries worldwide, with a particular focus on developing countries and small island developing States that often face capacity constraints in ocean governance. Key beneficiaries include national ministries, regional organizations and local communities.
- 14.48 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 14.7).

Table 14.7

Performance measure

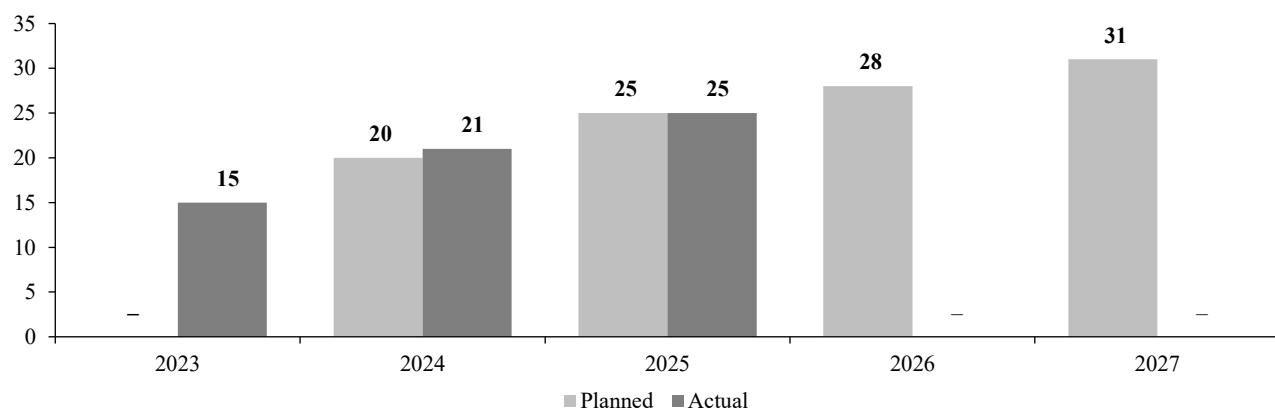
2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Agreement under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea on the Conservation and Sustainable Use of Marine Biological Diversity of Areas beyond National Jurisdiction adopted in June 2023	28 countries signed the Agreement	28 countries, including Liberia, Maldives, Panama and Seychelles, had undertaken national legal, regulatory and policy gap assessments, governance, institutional and administrative capacity gap assessments and scientific, technical and infrastructure capacity gap assessments for the implementation of their obligations under the Agreement

Planned results for 2027**Result 1: public sector institutions capture the economic contribution of biodiversity and ecosystem services in decision-making****Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 14.49 The subprogramme's work contributed to 4 additional public sector institutions capturing the economic valuation of biodiversity and ecosystem services in their policies, for a total of 25 institutions, which met the planned target.
- 14.50 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.VI).

Figure 14.VI

Performance measure: number of public sector institutions that capture the economic valuation of biodiversity and ecosystem services in their policies (cumulative)



Result 2: strengthened resilience of coastal reef ecosystems and local communities

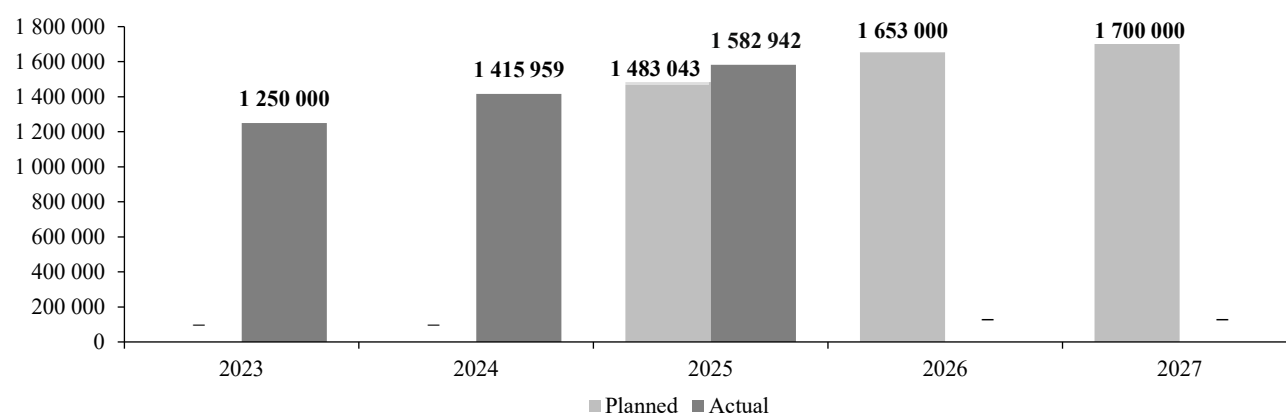
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.51 The subprogramme's work contributed to the improved management of 1,582,942 ha, which exceeded the planned target of 1,483,043 ha.
- 14.52 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.VII).

Figure 14.VII

Performance measure: area of coral reefs under improved management (cumulative)

(Hectares)



Result 3: expansion of sustainably managed and restored ecosystems

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 14.53 Sustainable ecosystem management can help protect biodiversity and help maintain clean and healthy fresh and coastal waters and fertile land. Through its sustainable ecosystem management initiatives, the subprogramme provides science-based policy guidance and supports the development of legal frameworks that strengthen governance and resource conservation. By offering technical tools, capacity-building and specialized expertise, the subprogramme empowers national ministries, regional organizations and local communities alike. By focusing on these beneficiaries, the subprogramme ensures that ecosystem management not only helps conserve biodiversity and restore degraded environments, but also reinforces institutional capacity and community resilience.

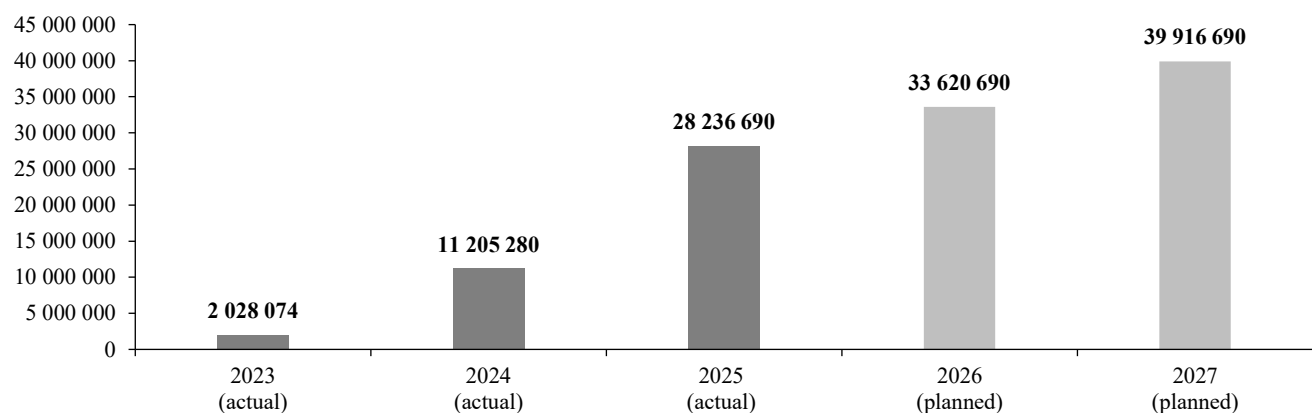
Lessons learned and planned change

- 14.54 The lesson for the subprogramme was that tailoring capacity-building support to the diverse institutional and technical contexts of beneficiary countries enhanced relevance, ownership and effectiveness and that flexible, demand-driven and modular approaches were better suited to responding to varying governance structures, resources and priorities. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will strengthen its approach by delivering technically robust and context-responsive support that empowers beneficiaries to apply ecosystem management tools effectively within their own institutional and environmental settings.
- 14.55 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.VIII).

Figure 14.VIII

Performance measure: increase in territory of landscapes and seascapes under sustainable management (cumulative)

(Hectares)



Deliverables

14.56 Table 14.8 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.8

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	4	6	3	2
1. Meetings of the governing bodies for multilateral environmental agreements	4	6	3 [4]	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	3	3	2	2
2. On ecosystem services	3	3	2 [3]	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	6	6	6	3
3. Seminars and training events on ecosystems management	6	6	6	3
Publications (number of publications)	7	14	4	4
4. On mainstreaming biodiversity in production sectors	2	2	1 [2]	1
5. On the knowledge, networks and funding available to influence public and private financial flows for conservation, management and sustainable use approaches, such as ecosystem-based approaches and nature-based solutions, to be implemented in a manner consistent with the relevant mandate	2	3	1 [2]	1
6. On marine and terrestrial ecosystems	2	3	1 [2]	1
7. On biodiversity and wildlife	1	6	1 [2]	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	6	8	6	3
8. On integrated ecosystem management (tools and methodologies)	3	4	3	1
9. On investing in nature (assessments, tools and methodologies)	3	4	3	2
C. Substantive deliverables				

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to Member States to implement the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework, supporting 138 countries participating in the early action support project for the Framework.

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
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D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: outreach campaigns on sustainable management and use of natural resources and the United Nations Decade on Ecosystem Restoration.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 14).

Subprogramme 4 Environmental law and governance

Objective

- 14.57 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to ensure that countries achieve environmental policy coherence and abide by strong legal and institutional frameworks that increasingly implement environmental goals in the context of sustainable development at the global, regional and national levels.

Strategy

- 14.58 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Facilitate relevant meetings and intergovernmental processes at the global, regional and national levels involving Governments, other United Nations entities, inter-agency mechanisms and regional ministerial forums through information management products, technical support and advisory services on environmental law and policy;
 - (b) Assist with the coherent implementation of multilateral environmental agreements by providing support to strengthen international and national efforts to achieve global environmental targets and by supporting Parties in national reporting to related conventions;
 - (c) Develop and disseminate innovative knowledge management tools and programmatic initiatives such as the United Nations Information Portal on Multilateral Environmental Agreements and the Programme for the Development and Periodic Review of Environmental Law (Montevideo Programme), supported by training, technical assistance and communication activities, including mainstreaming a gender perspective;
 - (d) Promote the uptake of environmentally sound practices across the United Nations system through the provision of policy advice and cooperate with United Nations country teams to mainstream lessons learned through the implementation of programmes, including replicating and scaling up interventions.
- 14.59 These workstreams will help Member States make progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, in particular Goals 5, 12, 13, 15, 16 and 17.
- 14.60 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Increased efficiency and effectiveness of environmental law and policymaking processes leading to coherent and science-based policies, including through Member States' concerted action on international environmental issues;
 - (b) Improved governance and partnerships with major groups and stakeholders in the development of synergistic national programmes, as well as increased integration of environmental considerations into national and subnational planning and budgeting processes on sustainable development.

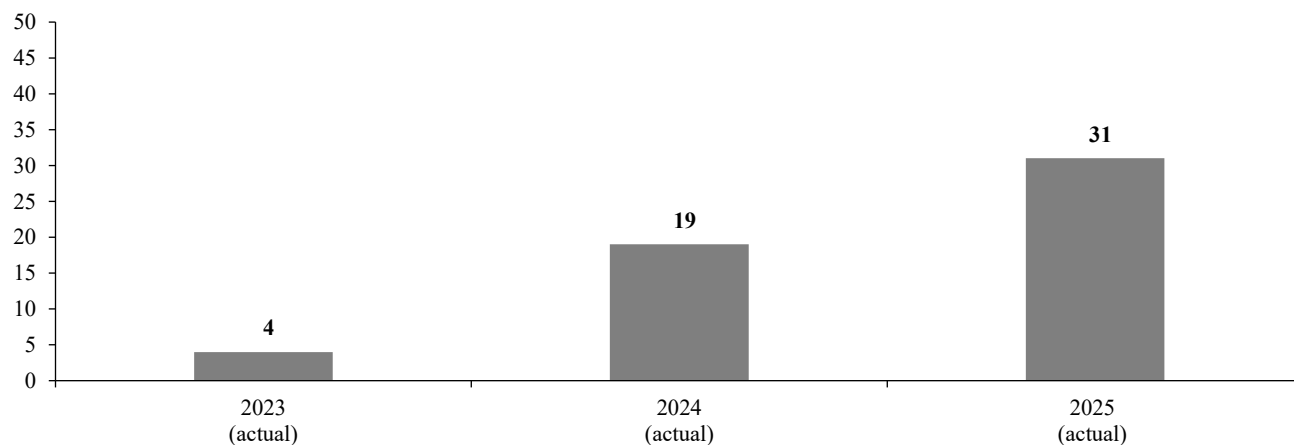
Programme performance in 2025

Member States advance legal frameworks and national strategies to address illegal waste trafficking

- 14.61 Illegal trafficking of waste remains a growing transboundary challenge in the Asia-Pacific region, with evolving waste trade flows and increasing volumes of plastic and hazardous waste placing pressure on enforcement and regulatory systems. UNEP, in partnership with the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), contributed to Member State representatives of environmental authorities, customs administrations and trade and industry ministries across the region enhancing their technical and operational capacities to detect, prevent and respond to illegal waste trafficking through strengthened regional cooperation, policy dialogue and knowledge exchange mechanisms. The subprogramme, which has the responsibility for advancing legal frameworks and national strategies to address illegal waste trafficking, supported a UNODC-UNEP regional technical seminar on waste trafficking and the circular economy approaches held in Kuala Lumpur. The subprogramme also held regional meetings in Bangkok and Jakarta to facilitate policy dialogue between the European Union and Association of Southeast Asian Nations member States, including Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand and Viet Nam, on waste trafficking trends and related regulatory frameworks.
- 14.62 As a result, Member State representatives improved their understanding of waste trafficking trends and enforcement challenges, advanced the development of legal frameworks and strategies to address illegal waste trafficking, including linkages to organized crime and trade systems, and strengthened alignment with regional circular economy approaches and national action planning processes.
- 14.63 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.IX).

Figure 14.IX

Performance measure: number of countries advancing legal frameworks and national strategies to address illegal waste trafficking (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

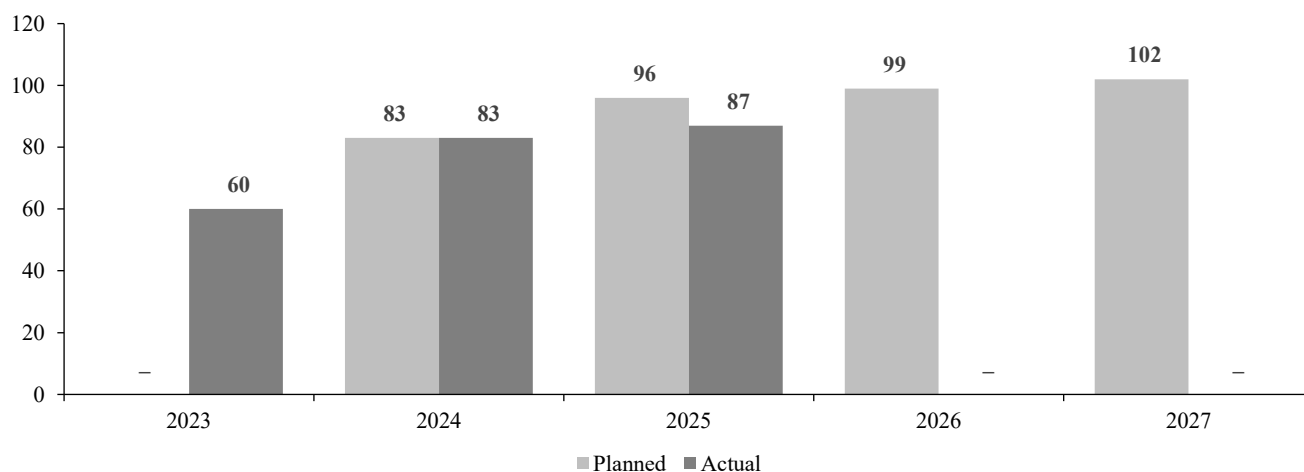
Result 1: reduced production and consumption of hydrofluorocarbons through the implementation of the Kigali Amendment to the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.64 The subprogramme's work contributed to 4 additional countries implementing the Kigali Amendment to the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer, for a total of 87 countries, which did not meet the planned target of 96. The target was not met because applicable parliamentary procedures are still ongoing.
- 14.65 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.X).

Figure 14.X

Performance measure: number of countries implementing the Kigali Amendment to the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer (cumulative)



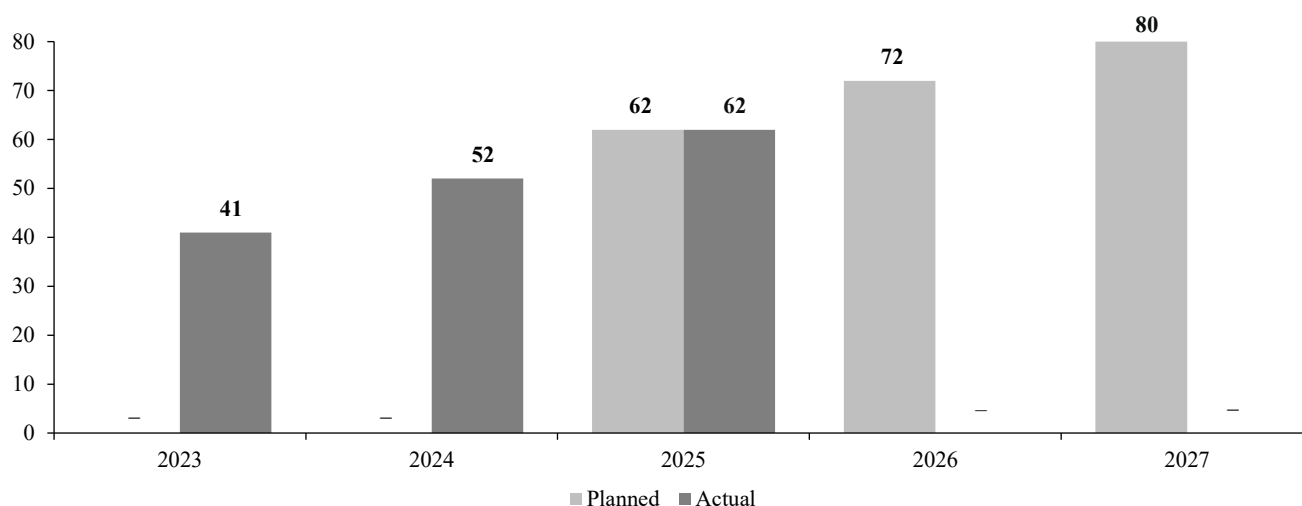
Result 2: legal stakeholders enhance the implementation and enforcement of environmental law

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.66 The subprogramme's work contributed to 10 additional countries strengthening the capacities of legal stakeholders to enhance the implementation and enforcement of environmental law, for a total of 62, which met the planned target.
- 14.67 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XI).

Figure 14.XI

Performance measure: number of countries with strengthened capacities of legal stakeholders on the implementation and enforcement of environmental law (cumulative)



Result 3: environmental objectives are integrated into national policy and legal frameworks

Proposed programme plan for 2027

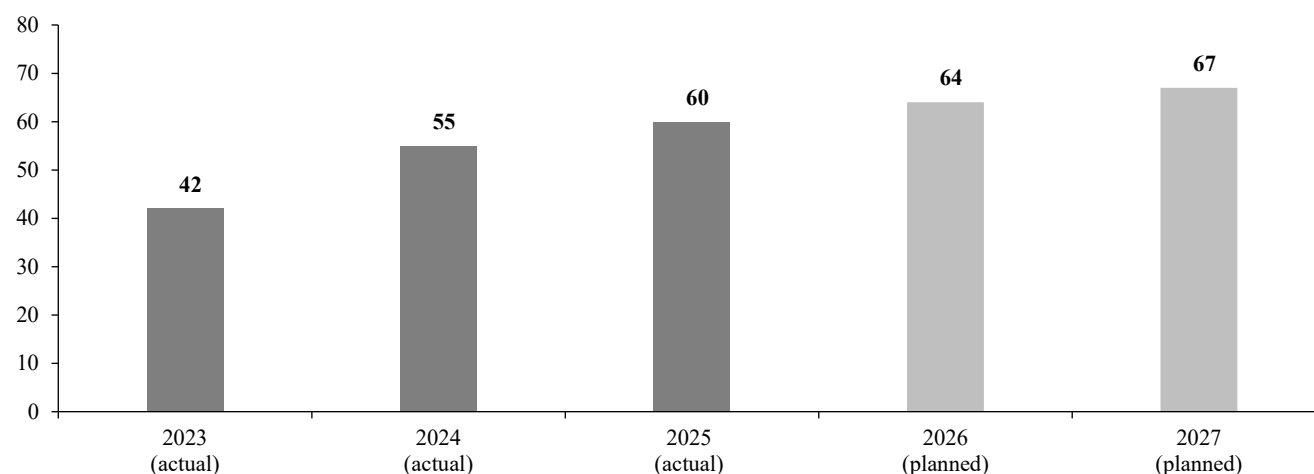
- 14.68 The integration of environmental objectives into national policy and legal frameworks help with the translation of internationally agreed environmental commitments into coherent national action. Through its work with Governments and relevant institutions, the subprogramme has supported the incorporation of environmental objectives into national policy and legal frameworks, contributing to improved coherence across sectors and stronger alignment between national development processes and internationally agreed environmental objectives.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 14.69 The lesson for the subprogramme was that the sustained integration of environmental objectives could be augmented when support was provided at key stages of policy and legal development, rather than after instruments had already been finalized. Experience showed that clearer articulation of environmental objectives within broader policy frameworks, and their linkage to planning, monitoring and budgetary processes, strengthened ownership and durability. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will place greater emphasis on timely and targeted technical and advisory support to assist in the integration of environmental objectives during the formulation and revision of national policy and legal frameworks, with a focus on strengthening cross-sectoral coherence and consistency with internationally agreed environmental objectives.
- 14.70 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XII).

Figure 14.XII

Performance measure: number of national policy and legal frameworks that integrate internationally agreed environmental objectives (cumulative)



Deliverables

14.71 Table 14.9 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.9

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Conference and secretariat services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	50	66	50	50
1. Meetings of the Committee of Permanent Representatives on environmental law and governance	50	66	50	50
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	16	15	12	6
2. On environmental law development and support to mainstream environmental issues, the implementation of multilateral environmental agreements and the linkages between poverty and the environment	16	15	12 [16]	6
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	15	24	10	10
3. Train-the-trainer events on environmental governance	15	24	10 [15]	10
Publications (number of publications)	3	2	2	1
4. On environmental law (global)	3	2	2 [3]	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to approximately 10 Member States, upon request, on the monitoring and implementation of multilateral environmental agreements, legislative strategies and frameworks to counter environmental degradation resulting from climate change and crimes that affect the environment.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: 5 online courses introducing various multilateral environmental agreements.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 14).

Subprogramme 5

Chemicals and pollution action

Objective

- 14.72 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to transition to a pollution-free planet, with a focus on reducing pollution in air, soil and water and thus ensure environmental quality and health for people and the planet.

Strategy

- 14.73 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide technical advice and capacity-building to Member States, the private sector and civil society, within the framework of relevant multilateral environmental agreements, the Global Framework on Chemicals – for a Planet Free of Harm from Chemicals and Waste and the broader international chemicals and waste agenda, with a view to strengthening legal, policy and regulatory frameworks and promoting the uptake of circular economy approaches and sustainable consumption and production approaches in key sectors and value chains;
 - (b) Promote the use of credible science and data on pollution and its sources, including through the new Intergovernmental Science-Policy Panel on Chemicals, Waste and Pollution;
 - (c) Collaborate with partners from the environment, health and other relevant sectors and support countries' efforts in addressing issues at the interface of environment and health, in order to achieve environmental and health benefits, including through actions to improve air quality and to address the environmental dimensions of antimicrobial resistance and other related issues, including through a One Health approach.
- 14.74 These workstreams will help Member States make progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, in particular Goals 3, 6, 11, 12 and 14.
- 14.75 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) A reduction in exposure to harmful chemicals and pollution;
 - (b) Countries developing, adopting, revising or implementing policies, laws or regulations that advance circular economy approaches, sound management for chemicals and waste and pollution prevention and control in key sectors;
 - (c) Private sector entities taking action to improve chemicals and waste management and reduce pollution;
 - (d) Sectoral and cross-sectoral efforts advancing positive outcomes for the environment and health.

Programme performance in 2025

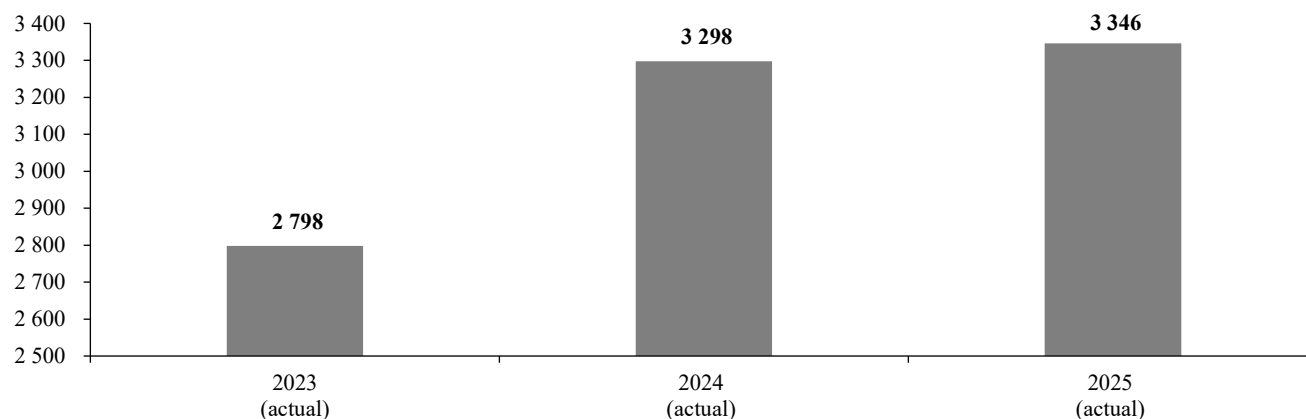
Chemicals of global concern and their waste reduced

- 14.76 Hazardous chemicals such as mercury, highly hazardous pesticides, persistent organic pollutants and their waste pose serious risks to human health and the environment. The subprogramme, in partnership with the Global Environment Facility, has worked with governments, other organizations and the private sector to cut emissions and safely dispose of chemicals of concern and their waste, including those covered by multilateral environmental agreements. UNEP has been supporting more environmentally sound practices and sustainable solutions, supported by targeted training and technical assistance in sectors where regulated chemicals are used. UNEP has also been supporting the strengthening of national and regional institutions to implement priority chemicals and waste interventions, including through the establishment of chemical observatories.

14.77 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XIII).

Figure 14.XIII

Performance measure: metric tons of mercury and persistent organic pollutants avoided and removed from the environment (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

Result 1: adoption of policies and practices to support circular economy approaches in high-impact sectors to reduce pollution

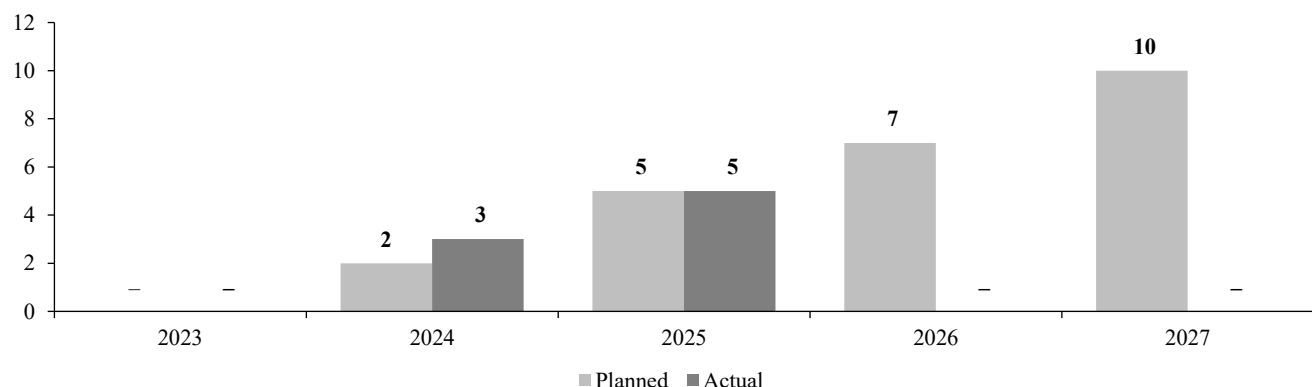
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

14.78 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development and implementation of the Framework Act on the Prevention and Sustainable Management of Waste in the Comoros and the development of a road map for mandatory plastic extended producer responsibility and guidelines for the recovery and recycling of plastic waste in Zimbabwe, for a total of five governments, including subnational governments, and producer responsibility organizations taking policy action to advance extended producer responsibility and similar scheme development to prevent and reduce pollution, which met the planned target.

14.79 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XIV).

Figure 14.XIV

Performance measure: number of governments, including subnational governments, and producer responsibility organizations taking policy action to advance extended producer responsibility and similar scheme development to prevent and reduce pollution (cumulative)



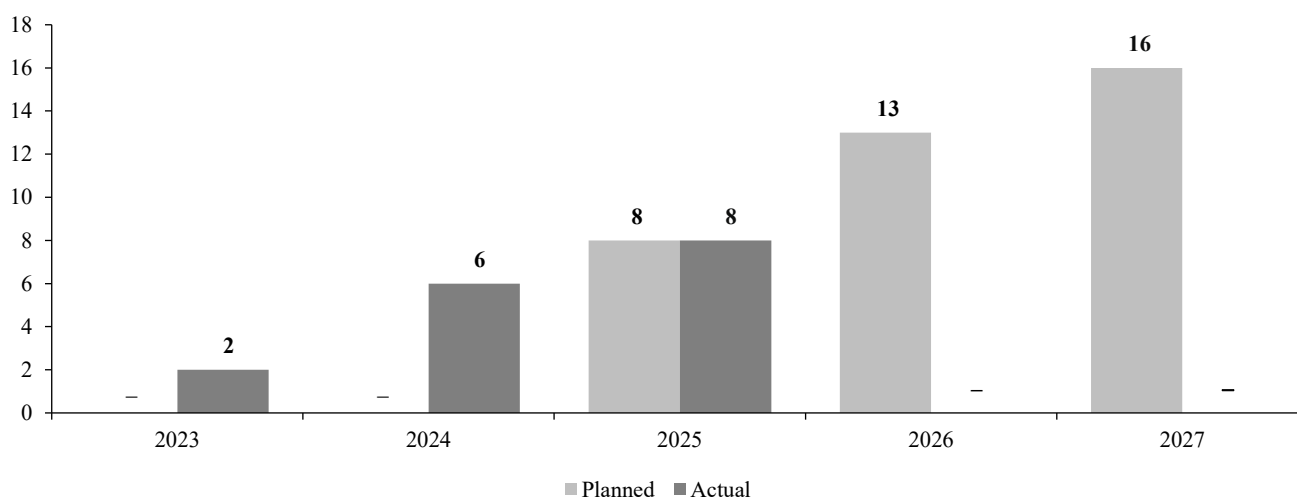
Result 2: adoption of policies and strategies to address the environmental dimensions of antimicrobial resistance

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.80 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development of a legal framework on antimicrobial resistance in Peru and a series of other initiatives, such as a UNEP-led workshop on the environmental dimensions of antimicrobial resistance in Guatemala, policy guidance, through its contribution to the advisory board of the Climate Change Impacts on Antimicrobial Resistance Using a Planetary Health Framework network, and tools that include the One Health Legislative Assessment Tool for Antimicrobial Resistance, school-based antimicrobial resistance education and the Quadripartite antimicrobial resistance toolkit series for young people, educators and policymakers, for a total of eight initiatives, policies, strategies or action plans undertaken by public or private actors from key economic sectors to address the environmental factors driving antimicrobial resistance, which met the planned target.
- 14.81 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XV).

Figure 14.XV

Performance measure: number of initiatives, policies, strategies or action plans undertaken by public or private actors from key economic sectors to address the environmental factors driving antimicrobial resistance (cumulative)



Result 3: Member States adopt policies, laws or regulations on chemicals and waste management in key sectors

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 14.82 The subprogramme continues to support the strengthening of capacities and legal, policy and regulatory frameworks for the sound management of chemicals and waste, including through the implementation of the Global Framework on Chemicals to enhance the sound management of chemicals and waste and by helping countries meet their commitments under conventions on chemicals and waste. UNEP provides secretariat services to the newly established Intergovernmental Science-Policy Panel on Chemicals, Waste and Pollution.

Lessons learned and planned change

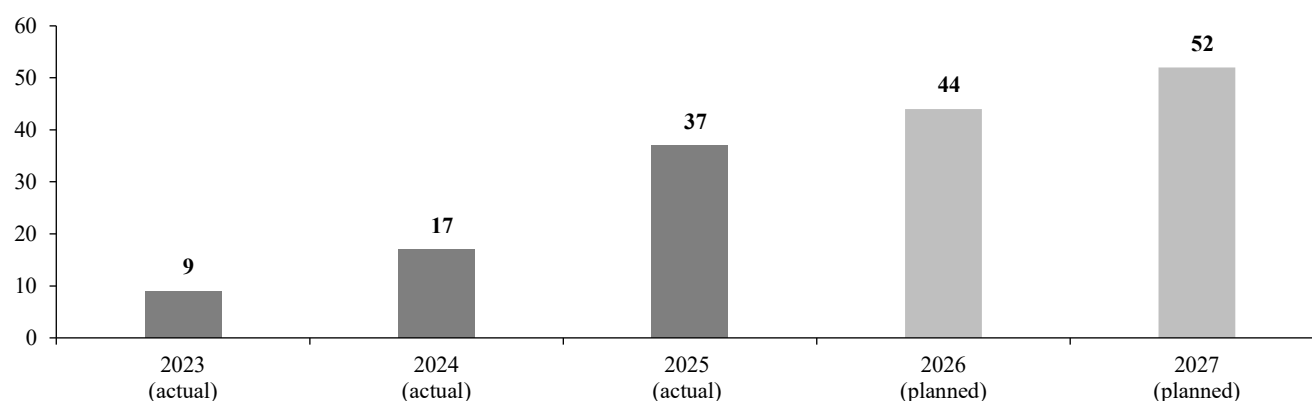
- 14.83 The lesson for the subprogramme was that anchoring its interventions in policy and regulatory action helped ensure durable progress in chemicals and waste management and pollution reduction. In

applying the lesson, the subprogramme will support countries in strengthening their legal, policy and regulatory frameworks for the sound management of chemicals and waste in key sectors such as plastics, textiles, minerals and metals, electronics transport and buildings and construction.

14.84 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XVI).

Figure 14.XVI

Performance measure: number of countries developing, adopting, revising or implementing policies, laws or regulations that advance sound management of chemicals and waste in key sectors (cumulative)



Deliverables

14.85 Table 14.10 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.10

Subprogramme 5: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	8	12	8	6
1. On the development of policies and legal, institutional or fiscal strategies and mechanisms for sound chemicals management	8	12	8	6
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	10	12	10	8
2. Seminars and training events on the sound management of chemicals and waste	10	12	10	8
Publications (number of publications)	1	2	1	1
3. Global assessment of the state of and trends in laws, regulations and fiscal policies for sound chemicals and waste management	1	2	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	6	8	6	4
4. On status, trends and related risks and improvements in chemicals and waste management at various scales	3	4	3	3
5. On action plans related to air quality at various scales, in particular at the subnational, national and regional levels	3	4	3	1
Fact-finding, monitoring and investigation missions (number of missions)	4	4	4	–
6. Monitoring missions on the status and trends relating to chemicals management, waste management and air quality, including on marine litter and other forms of pollution	4	4	4	–

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to 15 countries on pollution prevention and control.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: outreach programmes, campaigns and information materials for Member States and stakeholders to increase awareness of pollution prevention and reduction in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals.				

Subprogramme 6 Finance and economic transformations

Objective

- 14.86 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to ensure that countries and businesses integrate sustainability into economic, finance, legal and regulatory frameworks and catalyse public and private finance for sustainable consumption and production, circular economy approaches and business models in high-impact sectors.

Strategy

- 14.87 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support national and subnational governments in the design and implementation of policies and initiatives for sustainable consumption and production and circular economy approaches that reduce greenhouse gas emissions and pollutants and help restore ecosystem functions;
 - (b) Catalyse private sector investment for sustainability by engaging financial institutions and other private sector actors to align investment and lending with national development priorities, including support for small and medium-sized enterprises;
 - (c) Leverage public budgets and fiscal policies to mobilize private finance by advising Member States on public and fiscal measures that catalyse sustainable investment;
 - (d) Develop and refine metrics to track stocks and flows of natural and other forms of capital, by supporting the development and application of indicators that inform environmental, economic and financial decision-making;
 - (e) Support national and subnational governments in building institutional capacities and implementing development plans and policies and support businesses in adopting sustainable management and cleaner production practices across value chains.
- 14.88 These workstreams will help Member States make progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, in particular Goals 4, 8, 12, 13, 15 and 17.
- 14.89 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Governments and public and private sector institutions adopting or updating policy instruments and/or standards that accelerate sustainable consumption and production, including circular economy approaches and the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication;
 - (b) Governments implementing fiscal, budgetary and policy measures that unlock or redirect public and private finance towards sustainable investments aligned with climate-, biodiversity- and pollution-related objectives and objectives relating to circular economy approaches;

- (c) Banks and insurance institutions adopting governance arrangements, strategies, targets or disclosures to manage climate-, nature- and pollution-related risks and opportunities and reduce environmental footprints;
- (d) Increased use of UNEP-supported knowledge, data, metrics and assessments to inform decision-making and strengthen evidence-based policymaking.

Programme performance in 2025

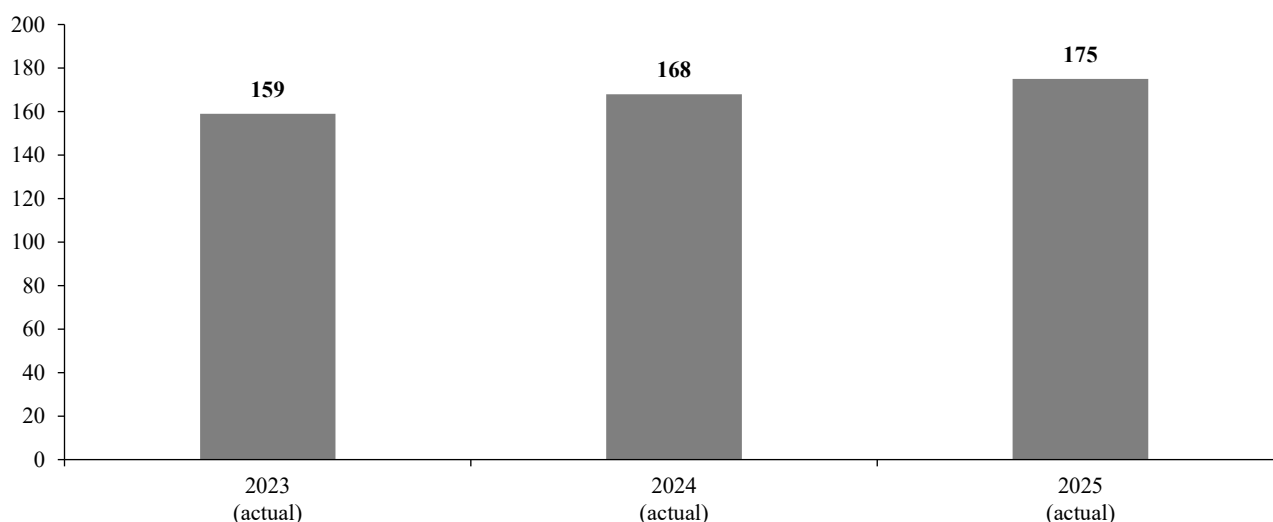
Insurance companies commit to sustainability approaches in their business practices

14.90 The Principles for Sustainable Insurance provide a global framework for the insurance industry to address environmental, social and governance risks and opportunities. The subprogramme works with insurers on incorporating elements of the Principles, including biodiversity-related risks consistent with the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. In parallel, support was provided to insurers for the development of market-based insurance solutions tailored to economies exposed to the adverse effects of climate change, improving access to insurance for small and medium-sized enterprises and strengthening financial resilience in the face of the adverse impacts of climate change. The subprogramme launched a report on how insurers can undertake nature-related dependency, impact, risk and opportunity assessments and, together with the Brazilian Insurance Confederation, held a global sustainable insurance summit at the 2025 United Nations Climate Change Conference, to reinforce the industry's role in contributing to a just, orderly and equitable transition away from fossil fuels in energy systems.

14.91 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.VII).

Figure 14.XVII

Performance measure: number of insurance companies that adopted the Principles for Sustainable Insurance (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

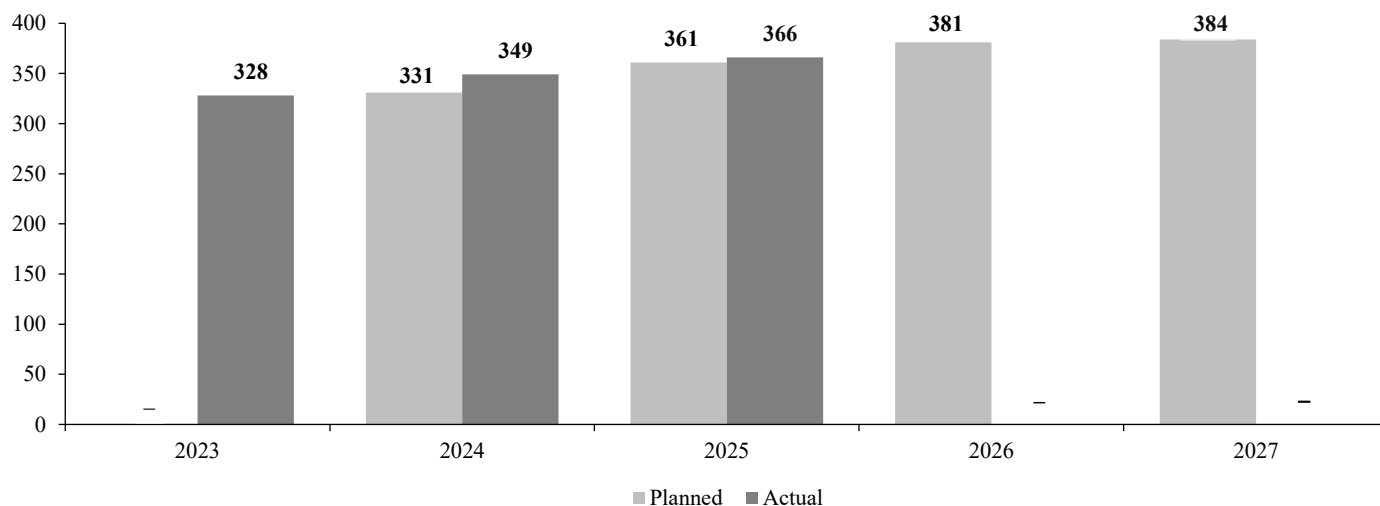
Result 1: increased availability of tools and measures to transform choices and behaviour by governments, businesses and individual consumers for environmental sustainability

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.92 The subprogramme's work contributed to an additional 17 consumer information and education tools and products that inform decision-making, choices and changes in behaviour towards sustainability, including digital product information systems, tools to improve product sustainability information, the UNEP Finance Initiative Portfolio Impact Analysis Tool for Banks and the EnABLE toolkit for sustainable infrastructure, for a total of 366 tools and products, which exceeded the planned target of 361.
- 14.93 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XVIII).

Figure 14.XVIII

Performance measure: number of consumer information and education tools and products that inform decision-making, choices and changes in behaviour towards sustainability (cumulative)



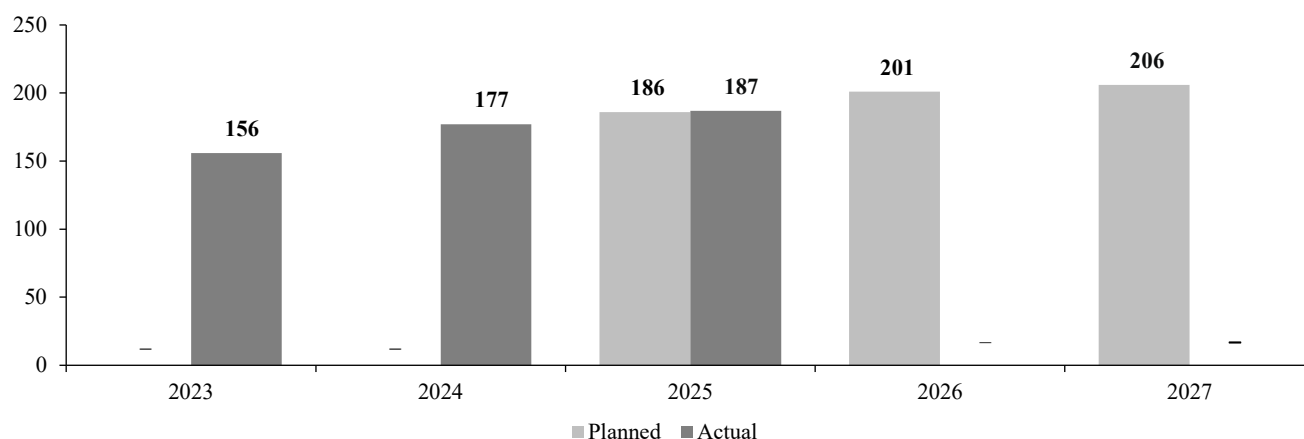
Result 2: accelerating progress towards sustainable consumption and production patterns

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.94 The subprogramme's work contributed to 187 initiatives taken by Member States in integrating sustainable consumption and production and economic and financial incentives into national planning, including a carbon label-based supply chain management initiative in China, the integration by Indonesia of sustainable consumption and production indicators and fiscal incentives into its development plan and a road map for sustainable finance and the circular economy in Kyrgyzstan, which exceeded the planned target of 186.
- 14.95 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XIX).

Figure 14.XIX

Performance measure: number of initiatives undertaken by Member States to integrate sustainable consumption and production and economic and financial incentives into national planning and/or sectoral strategies (cumulative)



Result 3: Member States adopt policies to increase sustainable finance

Proposed programme plan for 2027

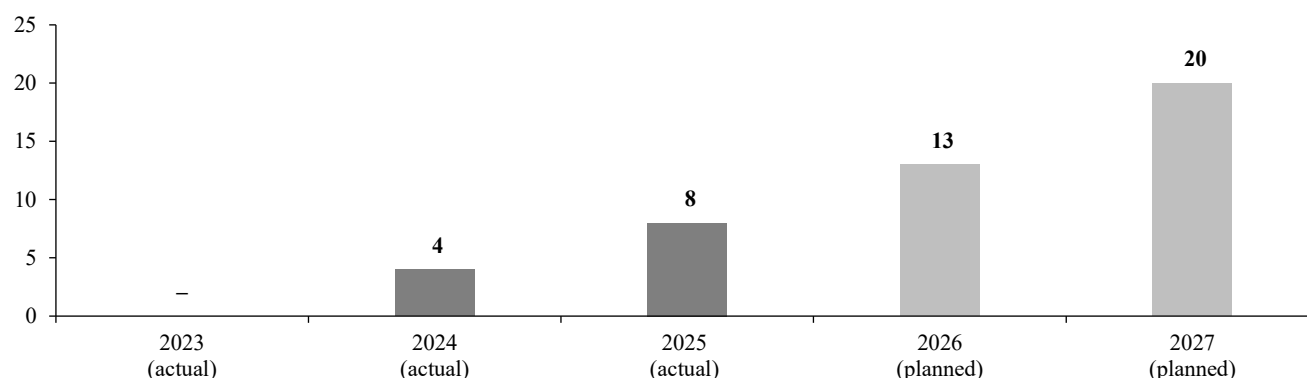
- 14.96 Government policy action can help facilitate the availability of public and private finance for investments with sustainability objectives. This subprogramme supports national and subnational governments, in collaboration with partners, in integrating sustainability into economic, fiscal and investment decision-making. Support is focused on budget formulation, fiscal reforms, public investment and incentive frameworks that influence the scale, direction and quality of finance in high-impact sectors, contributing to improved policy coherence and the alignment of public finance with environmental priorities, consistent with the Paris Agreement and the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 14.97 The lesson for the subprogramme was that incentives for financing a clean healthy and sustainable environment could be strengthened when fiscal and investment analysis was embedded in national budget cycles and aligned with country priorities. Sustained interministerial engagement, alignment with fiscal decision points and country ownership supported the translation of analysis into policy action. In applying this lesson, the subprogramme will support Member States in integrating policy packages that promote sustainable investments into budget preparation and expenditure reviews, with a specific focus on fiscal and investment instruments that have clear implementation pathways.
- 14.98 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XX).

Figure 14.XX

Performance measure: number of national and subnational governments that have taken policy action to increase sustainable finance (cumulative)



Deliverables

14.99 Table 14.11 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.11

Subprogramme 6: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	20	11	12	8
1. On finance and economic transformations	20	11	12 [16]	8
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	20	22	13	12
2. Seminars and training events on finance and economic transformation approaches	20	22	13 [15]	12
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	1
3. On finance and economic transformation approaches	2	2	2	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	8	11	3	2
4. On finance and economic transformations approaches	8	11	3 [5]	2
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: provide technical support to 4 Member States and/or stakeholders to accelerate the shift to sustainable consumption and production and circularity, with a focus on high-impact sectors; and convene 2 UNEP Finance Initiative regional round tables to share progress and strengthen cooperation on sustainable finance, including standard-setting, risk assessment and the management of climate change, nature and pollution issues.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: 1 tool developed by the Life Cycle Initiative to support life cycle analysis and inform decision-making for specific high-impact sectors; and the Sustainable Development Goal 12 hub (the “SDG 12 Hub”) is maintained and updated, facilitating the sharing of knowledge and best practices.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: 1 high-level dialogue on sustainable consumption and production convened under the 10-Year Framework of Programmes on Sustainable Consumption and Production Patterns to strengthen cooperation, leadership and commitment for action; and 2 consultations/workshops tailored to stakeholders (governments and the private sector) to build capacities and increase the uptake of sustainable public procurement, circular economy approaches and consumer information tools.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 14).

Subprogramme 7

Science-policy

Objective

- 14.100 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance the generation and utilization of quality environmental data and analyses by Governments and non-governmental actors, enabling a science-policy interface with a view to keeping the environment under review, building science-based environmental knowledge, identifying emerging issues and developing science-based policy globally, regionally and nationally, including for the achievement of the Goals.

Strategy

- 14.101 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Review the world environmental situation and strengthen the interface between science and policymaking across the sustainable development agenda, including through collaboration with the Statistical Commission and the five regional commissions;
 - (b) Develop scientifically credible and unbiased data, information and knowledge and provide policy-relevant analysis and policy recommendations to catalyse and accelerate solutions and action for the environment, based on a continuous review of the global status of the environment and trends;
 - (c) Catalyse systematic and transformative shifts that can drive progress towards the aspirations of achieving the environmental dimension of the 2030 Agenda, through gender-sensitive partnerships across all geographical areas, involving Governments and non-governmental organizations, the business and scientific communities, and citizens;
 - (d) Pursue broad stakeholder engagement as a critical step in enhancing societal understanding, acceptance and uptake of its scientific analysis and serve as a knowledge broker that builds consensus on existing and emerging environmental issues through platforms and networks, such as the Science-Policy-Business Forum on the Environment, the International Resource Panel, the World Adaptation Science Programme and the One Planet network;
 - (e) Provide analytical research, increase awareness about the environmental dimension of sustainable development and build capacity to measure, monitor and report on progress, helping Member States integrate common methods for tracking and measuring the environment-related Sustainable Development Goals, in particular Goals 1, 2, 4, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15 and 17, including in their national processes.
- 14.102 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Increased production and use of scientific environmental data by Member States and other stakeholders;
 - (b) A more coherent approach to harmonizing country data, to tracking progress and to science-based environmental policymaking, within and among countries;
 - (c) Member States improving their tracking and comparability of progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, which enhances coherence for the integration of national sustainable development plans and other internationally agreed environmental goals.

Programme performance in 2025

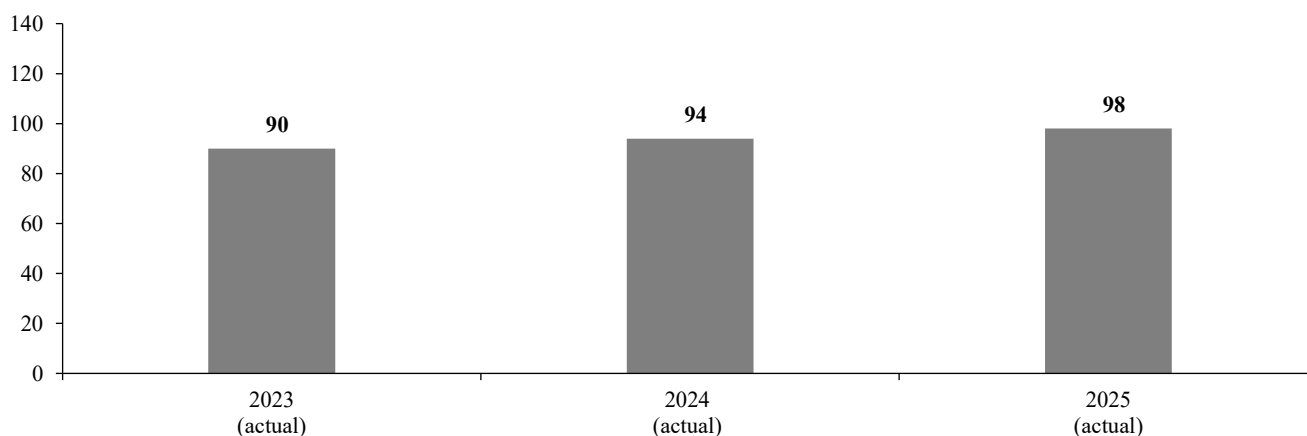
Countries implement the System of Environmental-Economic Accounting

- 14.103 UNEP has continuously supported national and regional capacities to generate, harmonize and use environment-related statistics in decision-making. One of the areas where the subprogramme has provided dedicated support to Member States is in the implementation of the System of Environmental-Economic Accounting. As at December 2025, UNEP has successfully co-conducted six targeted capacity-building events, including regional workshops, seminars and national technical training sessions on the System. The events covered 12 countries from the Asia-Pacific, Latin America and the Caribbean and Africa regions. UNEP also contributed to the global e-learning course on measuring material flows in the Sustainable Development Goals, organized by the Statistical Institute for Asia and the Pacific of the Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific. These efforts were built on previous work and ultimately contributed to 98 countries successfully putting in place functional systems for environmental-economic accounting, of which 71 are being implemented at the tier 3 level, meaning that they have institutionalized their compilation methodologies and are now compiling data on their environmental statistical accounts on a regular basis.

- 14.104 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XXI).

Figure 14.XXI

Performance measure: number of countries that implemented the System of Environmental-Economic Accounts (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

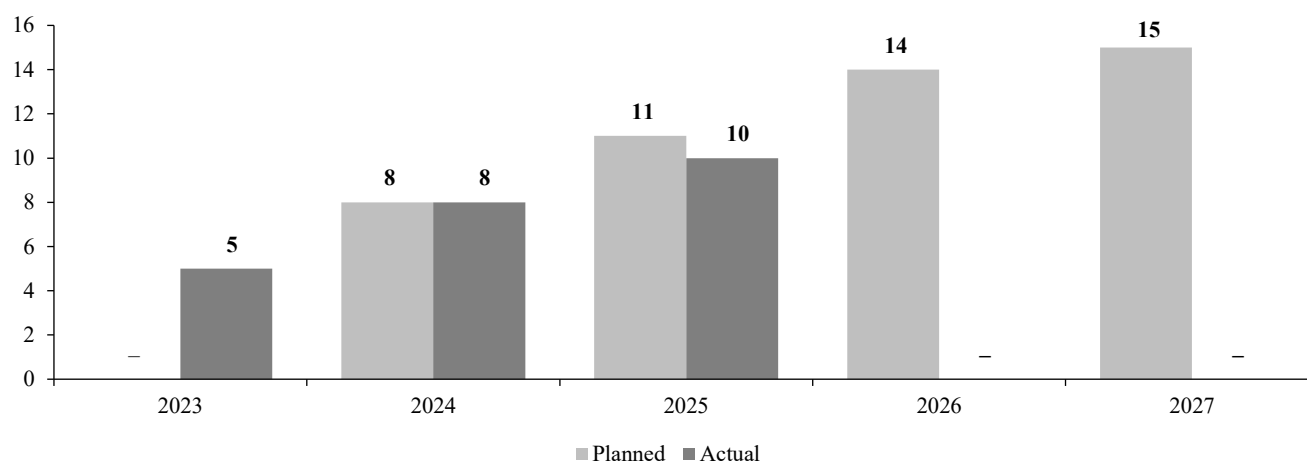
Result 1: improved electronic waste (e-waste) monitoring and collection

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.105 The subprogramme's work contributed to 2 additional countries establishing e-waste monitoring frameworks, for a total of 10, which did not meet the planned target of 11. The target was not met due to the inability of the subprogramme to recruit staff owing to the liquidity constraints.
- 14.106 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XXII).

Figure 14.XXII

Performance measure: number of countries that have established an e-waste monitoring framework (cumulative)



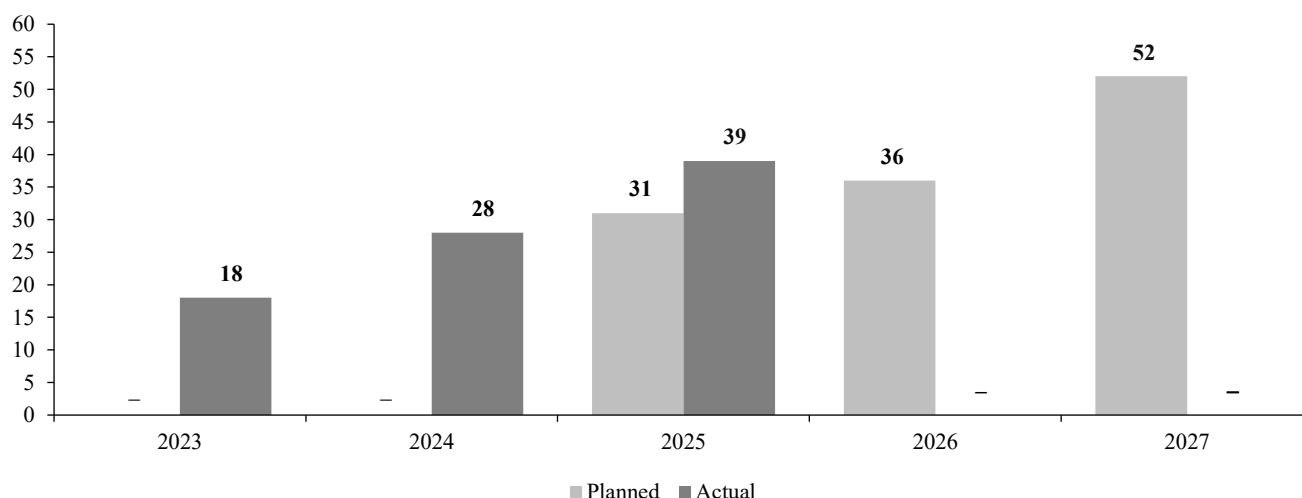
Result 2: strengthened science-policy interface in Latin America and the Caribbean

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 14.107 The subprogramme's work contributed to an additional 11 ministerial decisions for the Forum of Ministers of Environment of Latin America and the Caribbean, for a total of 39 decisions, which exceeded the planned target of 31.
- 14.108 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XXIII).

Figure 14.XXIII

Performance measure: number of ministerial decisions and related initiatives adopted in Latin America and the Caribbean informed by scientific evidence (cumulative)



Result 3: Governments and institutions use United Nations Environment Programme knowledge, data, statistics and assessments to inform policymaking

Proposed programme plan for 2027

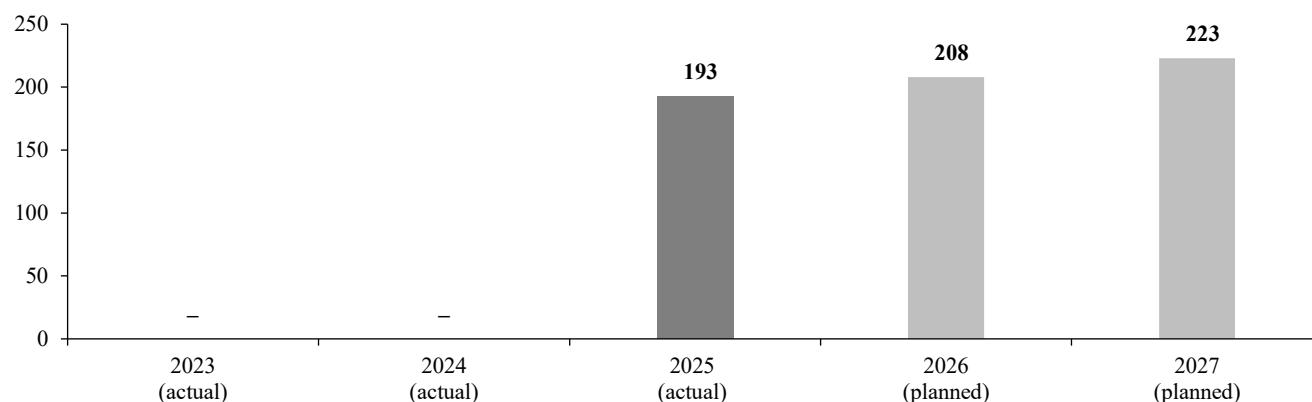
- 14.109 The subprogramme organizes regional ministerial forums, including the Forum of Ministers and Environment Authorities of Asia-Pacific, the African Ministerial Conference on the Environment and the Forum of Ministers of Environment of Latin America and Caribbean. The goal of these forums is to seek commitments to science-policy integration for tackling climate change, biodiversity loss and pollution. The subprogramme combines these in-person convenings with online modalities leveraging UNEP resources, to ensure the full integration of technical understanding following the in-person engagement. A key component of this practice has been virtual learning, which has broadened access and ensured that practical application, targeted follow-up and in-country technical assistance was maintained following in-person engagements.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 14.110 The lesson for the subprogramme was that progress in translating the commitments of the in-person convenings to policymaking and action towards sustainability often hinged on institutional capacity, the continuity of trained personnel and robust interoperable data governance approaches across national agencies. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will prioritize strengthening capacity-building using UNEP knowledge, data, statistics and assessments. The subprogramme plans to intensify post-training coaching and the formal designation of data custodianship in national institutions to enhance reporting continuity, data quality and the seamless integration of scientific evidence into policy and planning. This modality will inform 12 or more capacity-building initiatives in 2026 and 2027, equipping over 500 policymakers with skills for evidence-based decisions, including the outcomes of the seventh session of the United Nations Environment Assembly.
- 14.111 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 14.XXIV).

Figure 14.XXIV

Performance measure: number of Governments and institutions that use United Nations Environment Programme knowledge, data, statistics and assessments to catalyse policymaking and action (cumulative)



Deliverables

- 14.112 Table 14.12 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 14.12

Subprogramme 7: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^a</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	9	11	5	4
1. On keeping the environment under review	6	6	3 [6]	2
2. On supporting the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals	3	5	2 [3]	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	4	4	3	4
3. Seminar on keeping the environment under review	4	4	3 [4]	4
Publications (number of publications)	3	4	2	2
4. On keeping the environment under review (global)	3	4	2 [3]	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	3	4	2	3
5. On early warning and scientific assessments	3	4	2 [3]	3
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: consultation with some 25 Member States and stakeholders on methodology development and capacity development in data-collection methodologies relating to the Sustainable Development Goals; advice to at least 20 Member States and stakeholders on strengthening the science-policy interface; and advice to at least 25 Member States and stakeholders on implementing national environmental information systems.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: web pages, multimedia material and audio, video and social media content on the scientific work of UNEP to be utilized by Member States, stakeholders and the public.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in [A/80/6 \(Sect. 14\)](#).